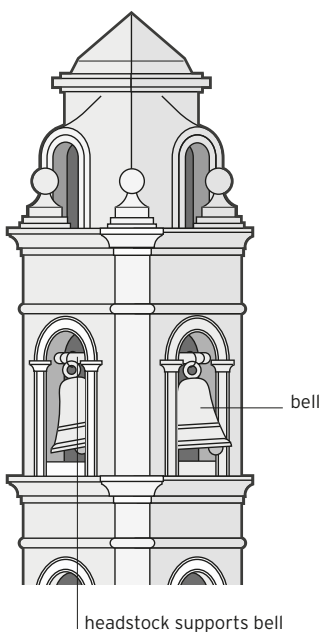


BEAM A horizontal structural component spanning an opening and carrying a load, such as a floor or wall. Traditionally, beams were wooden, but in modern construction they are more often concrete or steel.

BEAUX ARTS A grand style of architecture associated with the École des Beaux-Arts in Paris, which prevailed in France in the late 19th century. Buildings are typically large and elaborate with a symmetrical facade, their features derived from Classical Greek or Roman architecture. Interiors are similarly ostentatious, often featuring high, vaulted ceilings; central domes; and grand staircases. The style was popular in the US in the first decades of the 20th century. *See also* Classical.

BEEHIVE HOUSE A primitive circular structure with walls sloping inward as they rise to a rounded peak, like a cone. Common in ancient times, beehive houses are still found in some parts of the world today, including Syria.

BELFRY ▼ The upper part of a church tower where the bells hang. It is also sometimes used to refer to the entire tower.

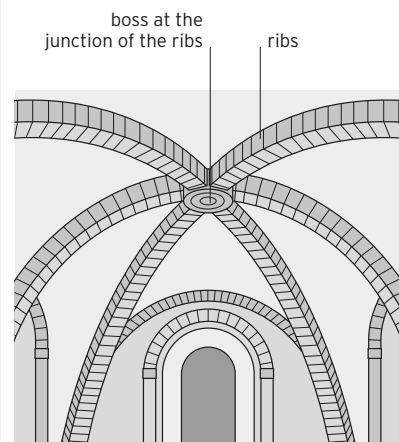


BELLCOTE A turret or small structure on a roof on which bells are hung.

BELVEDERE A structure built specifically to take advantage of an attractive view. It may be the upper part of a building or a free-standing element. The word comes from two Italian words, *bel* ("beautiful") and *vedere* ("view").

BERM A narrow shelf or path typically at the top or bottom of a slope. In a castle, the berm is the narrow area between the outer wall and its protective ditch or moat.

BOSS ▼ A carved ornament at the junction of stone vaulting ribs or roof beams. Bosses are often painted, and the subject of the carving is usually animals, birds, mythological beasts, or human faces. *See also* beam, rib vault.

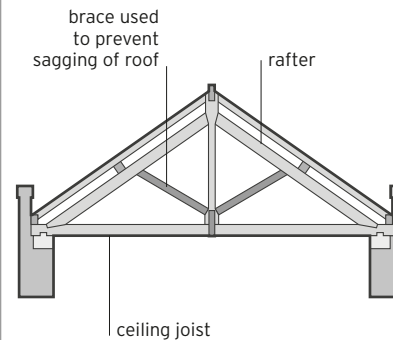


BOULEVARD A wide city road, usually in central or more affluent neighborhoods, with attractive landscaping and architecture.

BOX-FRAME A type of construction in which the external and internal concrete walls carry the weight of the floors and walls above. It is only suitable for buildings up to a

height of five stories and where individual cells or rooms on each floor conform to a similar grid, so that they form a structural frame.

BRACE ▼ A supporting wire, rope, or beam that steadies or holds something else erect.



BRACKET An element that projects from a wall to support an arch, beam, shelf, balcony, or statue. Brackets are often decorated in the form of scrolls and can sometimes be entirely ornamental.

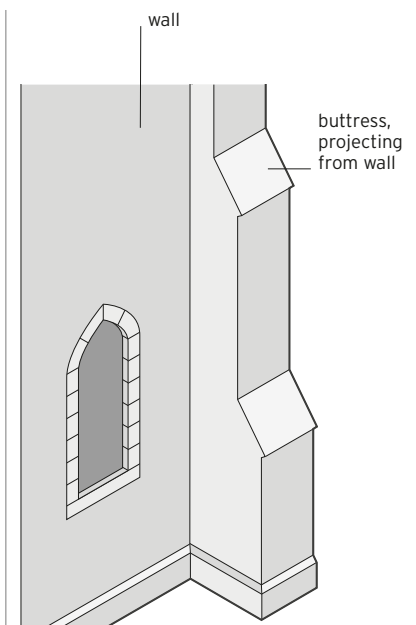
BREEZE BLOCK *See* cinder block.

BRISE-SOLEIL An external structure designed to provide protection from the Sun. It can take the form of baffles or lattices outside windows or can extend over the entire facade of a building.

BROCH A circular Iron Age stone structure found in Scotland. The exact function of brochs is a subject of debate, but many historians believe they were defensive in nature.

BRUTALISM An architectural style of the 1950s and 1960s characterized by monolithic blocklike forms and raw concrete construction.

BUDDHIST RAILING A stone barrier resembling a timber fence, with horizontal beams running through vertical posts.



BUTTRESS ▲ A structure that supports a wall. *See also* flying buttress.

BYZANTINE Relating to the Byzantine empire (395–1453 CE). Byzantine architecture typically combines elements from ancient Rome and eastern Mediterranean countries such as Syria.

C

CABLE MOLDING A type of convex molding that resembles a twisted rope.

CAISSON A boxlike structure used to keep construction dry in areas submerged in water. Caissons are commonly employed when building bridge piers.

CAMBER A convex curvature built into a beam to compensate for any anticipated sag when loaded.

CAME A metallic strip used to hold small pieces of glass to make a large panel, as in a stained-glass window. Comes are typically made of lead and are in H-shaped sections, with U-shaped sections for the borders.